Notebook Buying Priorities for Office Professionals

1. Introduction

Office workers and professionals prioritize a mix of core productivity attributes, with the clearest evidence pointing to **price, performance, display quality, reliability, and ergonomics-related usability** as the dominant factors when buying a notebook computer. Direct notebook studies report that professionals especially value display quality and keyboard comfort for long work sessions, while older professionals emphasize reliability and enterprise-oriented features; broader notebook market studies consistently rank price, CPU, RAM, display, and design near the top of purchase decisions (Maghsoudi et al., 2026).

The corpus is uneven, however. Only a small subset of papers directly isolates office workers or professionals as a notebook-buyer segment. Much of the stronger evidence comes from adjacent laptop-consumer studies, online review mining, conjoint analysis, and work-technology adoption literature that helps explain why professionals would prioritize productivity, comfort, reliability, and workflow fit over peripheral features (Maghsoudi et al., 2026; Kang et al., 2022; Liao & Chuang, 2021; Hua et al., 2023; Asan & Choudhury, 2021).

Do office workers and professionals prioritize productivity, reliability, and usability features when buying a notebook computer?

Requires at least 5 papers that directly answer your question. Try adjusting your query to find more papers.

FIGURE 1 Consensus on notebook priorities for professional users

The meter would favor **yes**. The most directly relevant evidence says professionals focus on display quality, keyboard comfort, reliability, and enterprise features, while the broader laptop literature repeatedly elevates price and core performance as primary purchase drivers (Maghsoudi et al., 2026; Liao & Chuang, 2021).

2. Methods

This Deep Search ran over more than 170 million research papers indexed in Consensus, spanning Semantic Scholar, PubMed, and other scholarly sources. The workflow began with 248,067 papers from the exact query, expanded through alternative phrasings and citation crawling, then screened 230 papers by relevance and retained 181 as eligible. The final synthesis includes the 50 highest-ranked papers supplied here, with emphasis on studies directly addressing laptop purchase criteria and on adjacent human-factors, ergonomics, and workplace-technology adoption papers that help interpret professional needs.

Search Strategy

51.3M Retrieved	→	2.3K Eligible	→	50 Included
21 searches 1 citation graph use All papers retrieved from 21 searches and 1 citation graph use.		Papers meeting relevance and quality criteria, after deduplication		Top papers selected to be included in the final analysis

FIGURE 2 Deep search screening and inclusion flow

Searches combined notebook purchasing terms with professional-user, workplace, ergonomics, digitalization, and feature-prioritization concepts to capture direct and adjacent evidence.

3. Results

3.1 Key Papers

The most important anchor papers are the notebook-specific prioritization studies and review-mining analyses, because they directly rank laptop attributes or identify what users discuss when making purchase decisions. The strongest direct segment-specific evidence for professionals comes from the study reporting that professional users focus on display quality and keyboard comfort, and older professionals prioritize reliability and enterprise features (Maghsoudi et al., 2026).

Paper	Summary
(Maghsoudi et al., 2026)	Ranks price, display, CPU, RAM highly (Maghsoudi et al., 2026)
(Su et al., 2025)	Finds design, setup, user experience central (Kang et al., 2022)
(Liao & Chuang, 2021)	Conjoint analysis puts price first (Liao & Chuang, 2021)

FIGURE 3 Key notebook preference papers in this corpus

3.2 Priority Features

Across direct notebook studies, **price** is the most consistently top-ranked feature, often followed by **display, CPU, RAM, design, storage, and battery** (Maghsoudi et al., 2026; Liao & Chuang, 2021). In the largest notebook-specific ranking here, the top five features were price, design, display, CPU, and RAM, with battery and storage in the next tier (Maghsoudi et al., 2026).

For professionals specifically, the pattern shifts from general consumer appeal toward work effectiveness. Display quality and keyboard comfort matter because they affect extended typing, reading, and productivity, and older professionals place extra weight on reliability and enterprise support (Maghsoudi et al., 2026). Supporting review-mining work on new laptops groups buyer attention around appearance design, setup, and user experience, with logistics and after-sales service as secondary but still relevant supporting-service factors (Kang et al., 2022).

3.3 Lower-Priority and Contextual Features

Some notebook attributes appear to matter far less in purchase choice. In the TOPSIS ranking, webcam, fan, and charger were the lowest-priority features, suggesting they are expected baseline components rather than purchase differentiators (Maghsoudi et al., 2026). Keyboard also ranked low in that all-consumer ranking, which contrasts with the segment-specific evidence that professionals care about keyboard comfort, implying that occupational subgroup analyses can reveal needs hidden in aggregate consumer data (Maghsoudi et al., 2026).

Battery importance appears to have risen in more recent post-pandemic review analyses, consistent with more mobile and hybrid work patterns (Park et al., 2024). Global sentiment analysis also identifies battery life and cooling efficiency as universal concerns, while developed-country users express relatively stronger demand for high performance and advanced features and developing-country users emphasize affordability, durability, and reliability (Maghsoudi et al., 2025).

3.4 Professional Work Requirements

The broader workplace and human-factors literature helps explain which notebook features professionals are likely to prioritize even when laptop studies do not name them directly. Ease of use, low complexity, and smooth workflow integration are central to technology acceptance among professionals, while multiple logins, poor infrastructure, and inadequate support are barriers (Alotaibi et al., 2025; Hua et al., 2023).

Ergonomics also matters for office workers because musculoskeletal disorders are common among computer users, especially with prolonged use, awkward posture, lack of breaks, and poor ergonomics training (Demissie et al., 2024). That makes **screen quality, keyboard comfort, weight, docking/port support, and reliable connectivity** plausible professional priorities, even though only some are directly ranked in notebook-choice studies. Remote-work studies further show that communication quality, connectivity, and technical reliability become salient when work depends on video calls and collaboration tools (Ferreira et al., 2021).

Results Timeline

Notebook preference research has moved from broad consumer ranking toward context-specific and workplace-aware interpretation.

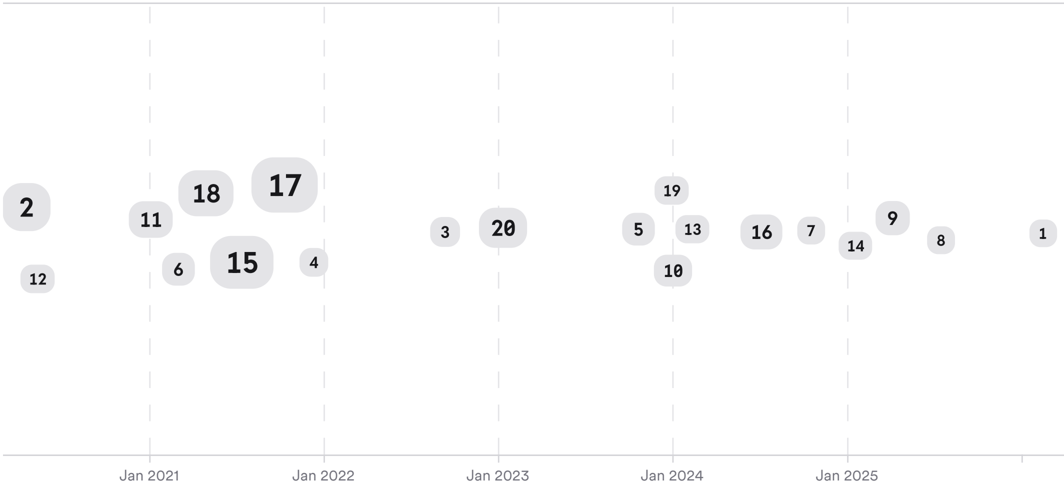

FIGURE 4 Timeline of notebook preference research, larger markers indicate more citations

The arc runs from earlier work on brand, price, and broad purchase motives to recent studies using review mining and sentiment analysis to detect finer feature-level preferences. More recent work also reflects hybrid-work pressures, especially rising battery importance, usability, and workflow fit (Çakır & Pekkaya, 2020; Ghosh et al., 2023; Park et al., 2024).

Top Contributors

Within this corpus, a small set of recurring authors contributes much of the direct notebook-preference evidence, while journals in consumer technology and operations research carry many of the most relevant studies.

Type	Name	Papers
Author	Mehrdad Maghsoudi	[3712fedc1da850278e4cb33d2cfae001][ded252e0c0b252e9b34e5a34a11bf886]
Author	Mohammadreza Bakhtiari	[3712fedc1da850278e4cb33d2cfae001][ded252e0c0b252e9b34e5a34a11bf886]
Author	Hamidreza Bakhtiari	[3712fedc1da850278e4cb33d2cfae001][ded252e0c0b252e9b34e5a34a11bf886]
Journal	*PLOS One*	[3712fedc1da850278e4cb33d2cfae001]
Journal	*IEEE Access*	[ded252e0c0b252e9b34e5a34a11bf886]
Journal	*Journal of Business Research*	[1b7e49b31cda5517978d3d00996ff2e6][6cf5f3e6fd2e5727a74781f5e00d0b3c]

FIGURE 5 Authors and journals appearing most in included papers

4. Discussion

The best-supported answer is that professionals prioritize **productivity-enabling fundamentals** first, not flashy extras. Direct evidence for professionals points to display quality, keyboard comfort, reliability, and enterprise features, while adjacent notebook studies repeatedly rank price and core performance hardware near the top (Maghsoudi et al., 2026; Liao & Chuang, 2021).

The evidence is strongest for broad laptop-buyer priorities and moderate for profession-specific priorities. Only one paper in this corpus directly states professional users' distinct preferences, so claims about office workers specifically rely partly on inference from ergonomics, remote work, and professional technology-acceptance literatures (Maghsoudi et al., 2026; Alotaibi et al., 2025; Demissie et al., 2024; Ferreira et al., 2021). That inference is reasonable because these adjacent literatures consistently show that professionals value tools that reduce effort, support long-duration use, and fit workflow.

There is also a clear mismatch between aggregate consumer rankings and professional subgroups. For example, keyboard ranks low in one general notebook ranking but high in the segment-specific statement about professionals, showing that market-wide averages can obscure occupational needs (Maghsoudi et al., 2026). The same likely applies to ports, enterprise security, docking support, and service quality, which appear in broader service or reliability categories but are rarely isolated cleanly in the notebook-choice studies here (Maghsoudi et al., 2026; Kang et al., 2022).

Claim	Evidence Strength	Reasoning	Papers
Professionals value **display quality** and **keyboard comfort** for extended work	Moderate	Directly stated for professional users, but from limited segment-specific evidence	(Maghsoudi et al., 2026)
Price is a top notebook purchase criterion	Strong	Repeated across ranking, conjoint, refurbished, and global preference studies	(Maghsoudi et al., 2026; Liao & Chuang, 2021; Ghosh et al., 2023)
CPU, RAM, display, and performance are central buying factors	Strong	Consistent across notebook-specific feature rankings and market analyses	(Maghsoudi et al., 2026)
Reliability and durability are especially important for professional/business contexts	Moderate	Supported by older-professional and developing-market/business-oriented evidence	(Maghsoudi et al., 2026; Maghsoudi et al., 2025)
Webcam, fan, and charger are major purchase differentiators	Weak	Direct evidence points the other way; these rank lowest in one feature-priority study	(Maghsoudi et al., 2026)

FIGURE 6 Key claims and evidence across included studies

5. Conclusion

Across this corpus, office workers and professionals appear to prioritize notebook features that support **productive, comfortable, reliable daily work**. The clearest professional-specific priorities are **display quality, keyboard comfort, reliability, and enterprise features**, while the broader laptop literature consistently adds **price, CPU, RAM, battery, and overall design/build quality** to the top tier (Maghsoudi et al., 2026; Liao & Chuang, 2021).

Research Gaps

The main gap is that few studies directly isolate office workers or professionals as a notebook-buying segment. Most evidence comes from general consumer samples, review mining, or adjacent workplace literatures rather than procurement-focused professional cohorts.

Topic/Outcome	Professional cohorts	Direct feature ranking	Long-term use outcomes	Hybrid-work context
Display and keyboard comfort	1	2	1	1

Topic/Outcome	Professional cohorts	Direct feature ranking	Long-term use outcomes	Hybrid-work context
Reliability and enterprise features	1	1	1	1
Battery and mobility priorities	2	3	1	2
Ergonomics and musculoskeletal outcomes	3	GAP	4	2

Open Research Questions

Future work should connect laptop purchase criteria to actual professional work outcomes, not just consumer sentiment or stated preferences.

Question	Why
Which notebook features most improve productivity and comfort for office workers over a full workday?	Current studies rank preferences, but rarely link specific notebook features to measured productivity, fatigue, or musculoskeletal outcomes.
How do professional priorities differ across hybrid, office-only, and travel-heavy work patterns?	Battery, connectivity, weight, and display needs likely vary by work mode, but the corpus does not isolate these groups well.
Which enterprise features actually drive willingness to pay among professional buyers?	Reliability and enterprise support are mentioned, but concrete trade-offs against price and performance remain under-specified.

Office workers and professionals buying a notebook computer prioritize **price, performance, display quality, reliability, and work comfort**, with peripheral features generally ranked much lower.

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